

RED TIDE

Red land crabs live in the forests of Christmas Island in the Indian Ocean. In October of every year, 30 million of them leave their burrows and migrate to the coast to breed, swarming over the island like a red tide. A few days after reaching the shore, the females release their eggs into the ocean. The young crabs live in the sea for a month before returning to land.

▼ PRECIOUS CARGO

The female crabs carry their eggs beneath their bodies for two weeks before releasing them in the sea.



COCONUT MONSTER

The biggest and most impressive land-living crabs are the tropical robber crabs. These giants can weigh up to 9 lb (4 kg)—as much as a domestic cat. Despite this, they climb trees, especially coconut palms growing on tropical islands. They often eat coconuts, and are sometimes known as coconut crabs. But like other land crabs, they have to return to the sea to lay their eggs.

▲ POWERFUL PINCERS

Robber crabs feast mainly on coconuts, using their massive pincers to crack open the hard shells. But some have been known to prey on chickens, as well as other robber crabs.

